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—Stephen Bryant, Ziff-Davis

a meaningful name? We’re predicting that the awareness of the need for proper tagging—as in a collective awareness of the Internet community—will increase, which will, in turn, increase search relevancy.

Which brings us to Google Base: did you know there’s base.google.com? At that page, you sign in, and just upload content. Any content. You need to tag it first. People will then be able to find your stuff. Yes, content itself is getting more user-driven, but that’s a topic for another tale...

Thinking about Google Base, it struck us: what about a P2P Google? A Google that searched for stuff all over willing people’s computers? Imagine our dismay when we Googled “P2P Google” and discovered someone had beaten us to the idea! The culprit was Ziff-Davis’ Stephen Bryant, in December 2005: “And as Google’s Desktop applications land on more and more hard drives, I wouldn’t be surprised if we saw Google get into the P2P space. Imagine searching, not only the Web, but also the information that other people make public on their hard drives.”

No talk of search can skip out on advertising. Some of you use Adblock in Firefox. Some of us use a script that even blocks Google ads. Now, Milind Mody, CEO of eBrandz, a leading Indian SEO, has this to say: “If Google realises a lot of

people are blocking their ads, they will detect usage of such scripts and ban those IPs from getting search results.” Then, Mody says, there will likely be an increased tendency to highlight paid search results. He also sees search engine spam reducing, with Google and others now taking longer to rank a site after it’s been indexed. In sum, expect a cleaner Google.

Personalised Search is what will change the face of our favourite Internet activity the most. We don’t understand why more people don’t actually use the Personalisation feature in Google. If you use it, you’ll get more relevant results in future searches. Don’t want the Internet to know what you’ve been searching for? Why, what *really* is your concern that some server somewhere in faraway California knows what you do online? Sun’s Scott McNealy said it the way it is: “You already have zero privacy. Get over it.”

Have we been unfair in mostly talking Google all this while? Well, are you being unfair when you say you just Xeroxed a document?

Google wants to index “all the world’s information” and make it available, as you know. Now CEO Eric Schmidt has said, on record, about this: “It is important that we not be stopped.”

Yes, it’s important. We want. Please give. What else can we say? ☒

For My Eyes Only

The Web will eventually be what you want it to be—yours. You’ll see a customised version served just for you

The problem: too much information. The answer: personalisation. We’re envisioning a Web where, once you sign in to your Desktop or mobile device, you’re recognised for what you are as an online entity. And you get *only* what you need, what you want, what you like. Like for downloads: suppose you’re only looking for freeware—why should the Web show you non-freeware? You’ll stop seeing unnecessary ads like “check your credit score” (which applies only to Americans)—and those much-hated ads for \$10 broadband! Already, sites are recognising your IP, and are sending out targeted ads—and we’re talking targeted content, too.

We remember a concept of long ago, called OneName, where you put in *all* your details, and OneName-supporting sites would recognise you. That was in 1999, and it goes to show that “recognising” one all over the Web is hardly a tough proposition.

Personalised newsletters are a simple implementation of the “learning about you” concept: Findory.com, for example, will send you a news e-mail each day containing only news you’re likely to read, based on what you read in the past.



Photograph sandeep Patil
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